

Competitive Landscape

Architecture & Design — Global Digital Presence Audit

01. BIG — Bjarke Ingels Group

big.dk

High-energy, media-friendly, parametric. Strong storytelling via project videos and Bjarke as public persona.

STRENGTHS

- Excellent video-first portfolio
- Clear project narrative on each page
- Strong social media presence
- Bjarke as a recognized global brand

WEAKNESSES

- Oversaturated with content — difficult to find depth
- Feels commercial rather than cultural
- Copy is promotional, not authoritative

COMPETITIVE THREAT

High for media visibility. Low for institutional gravitas.

02. Zaha Hadid Architects

zaha-hadid.com

Iconic, luxury, parametric. The brand is inseparable from Zaha Hadid's legacy — which is both a strength and a constraint.

STRENGTHS

- Immediately distinctive visual language
- Strong project imagery
- Clear association with innovation and spectacle

WEAKNESSES

- Post-Zaha brand is undefined
- Site is portfolio-only — no editorial voice
- Tone is cold and institutional

COMPETITIVE THREAT

Moderate. Competes directly for high-profile commissions. Brand is weaker since 2016.

03. Adjaye Associates

adjaye.com

Cultural, civic, rooted in place and materiality. Strong alignment with African diaspora institutions and global cultural commissions.

STRENGTHS

- Clear mission and values on site
- Strong civic and cultural positioning
- Excellent project photography

WEAKNESSES

- Site is slow and not mobile-optimized
- Limited editorial content
- Portfolio depth is modest compared to Snøhetta

COMPETITIVE THREAT

Moderate. Competes for cultural commissions. Different geographic focus.

04. Studio Gang

studiogang.com

Research-driven, sustainable, civic. Strong Midwest + North America positioning. Jeanne Gang as public intellectual.

STRENGTHS

- Clear research-to-design narrative
- Strong sustainability credentials
- Good press coverage and publications

WEAKNESSES

- Primarily North American — limited global brand
- Site does not convey scale or ambition beyond portfolio

COMPETITIVE THREAT

Low for global commissions. High for North American civic projects.

05. Gensler

gensler.com

Corporate, data-driven, workplace-focused. Reports and research are primary content. Design is secondary.

STRENGTHS

- Enormous project volume
- Strong workplace and corporate brand
- Annual Design Survey is industry-standard reference

WEAKNESSES

- No artistic or cultural ambition on the site
- Feels like a consulting firm
- Brand is interchangeable with other large corporate firms

COMPETITIVE THREAT

Low. Different market and client type entirely.

Strategic Summary

Snøhetta's core competitive advantage is interdisciplinary depth combined with Scandinavian restraint. No direct competitor combines civic credibility, cultural gravitas, and genuine brand presence at the same level. The gap to close is not work quality — it is digital communication quality. The site must perform at the same level as the buildings.